



148 Civilization IV



154 Five Months To A Million



168 "No eLay," says Electra

Digital Leisure

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Lead Feature

Trust No One!

That's the motto being promoted by security software companies across the globe. But is such paranoia really warranted?

Agent 001

It was a bright, but cold, winter morning. As is customary, I awoke, switched on my monitor (my PC is always on), put the tea-kettle on the fire, and sat down to check e-mail. This has been my morning ritual for as long as I can remember, and takes precedence over age-old rituals such as wishing my family Good Morning. Yes, I am a geek, and proud of it!

This particular morning, I started up Opera, which has my Gmail account configured in its inbuilt e-mail client, and clicked Check/Send. "Fetching messages 1/47" it said, so I sighed and went

back to the kitchen to nurture my feeble tea-making skills. About 10 minutes later I returned to see the dreaded error message from Avast! Antivirus, proclaiming, "A virus was found!" Panic set in; I rushed to my PC, half-spilling my tea along the way, and promptly clicked the Delete option in the pop-up. "Ahh, problem solved," I rejoiced, after Avast! gave me the all clear sign.

It was only an hour later that I realised how foolish I had just been—when I accidentally stepped on a sticky tea stain on the floor. This got me thinking:

"Why are we so paranoid about security?"

Yes, I realise that this sounds like a silly question to the overwhelming majority of the computing world, but I found myself asking this question anyway. So I got a virus, and that too, one that my anti-virus detected; what's the big deal? It's not like the virus, whatever it was, could have done any harm once Avast! had detected it. It was in an e-mail anyway, in Opera, so it's not like I tried to exe-

